



GERMANS

TODAY, GERMANY HAS THE THIRD LARGEST ECONOMY in the world, perhaps because Germans tend to be so organized and thorough in their affairs. Yet until recently there were actually two Germans. The

NO LONGER DIVIDED INTO TWO NATIONS



FRIESIAN FOLK

Both the Netherlands and Germany have Friesian populations who traditionally live a rural life and keep animals. Windmills and cottages (often thatched) dot the region.

THE FIFTH SEASON

During the carnival in the village of Bad Waldsee, revelers wear costumes or traditional hand-crafted wooden masks to parade through the streets. It only lasts a few days but the carnival is so important that it is referred to as the “fifth season” of the year.

A unified country

Germany's 16 states each have their own capital and regional government. Prior to reunification, East Germany was one of the richest of the communist countries, yet its citizens experienced a considerable degree of material hardship and cultural repression compared to the people of West Germany. Today, the gap in prosperity between these two groups still persists, though it is slowly closing.



CARNIVAL IN COLOGNE

The highlight of Cologne's carnival is the *Rosenmontag* (Rose Monday) procession. Dozens of floats decorated with huge figures relating to topical events move through the streets, and candies and flowers are thrown into the crowd.